

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 5 2
 ♥ K J 9 4 2
 ♦ 2
 ♣ Q 9 8 5

♠ K Q T 9 4

♥ A 8 6

♦ 9 5

♣ K T 4



♠ 8 6

♥ Q T 7

♦ A 8 7 6 3

♣ 7 3 2

♠ J 7 3

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J T 4

♣ A J 6

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♠

2 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

The bidding has been as shown.

It is the sign of a novice to support responder's 1-level response with only 3 of the suit. Very often he will have responded in a 4-card suit and you end up playing in a 7-card fit.

But that is not the case here. If partner had only 4 ♠s he would not have bid the suit, he would have made a Negative Double. Since his ♠ bid promises 5 it is quite correct for you to support with only 3. So you raise to 2 ♠ and partner bids the game.

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 8 4 2
 ♥ Q J 7 6 4
 ♦ 7 5 3
 ♣ -

♠ A K 7 5

♥ A 9 8 3

♦ K 8 6

♣ 9 5



♠ Q

♥ K

♦ Q J T 9 4

♣ A J 7 4 3 2

♠ 9 6 3

♥ T 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ K Q T 8 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

Dbl

All Pass

2♣ by East

The bidding has been as shown.

First let's agree on what you **DON'T** say. You don't say "double" because that would be a Negative Double showing at least one 4-card Major. You don't support partner's ♦s with just two of them. You probably don't bid 1NT with no honor in either Major. So you pass. This is called a "Trap Pass". Partner re-opens with a double.

Now you see why it's called a "Trap Pass". When an overcall is followed by two passes Opener should try to find another bid. In particular he should try to double for takeout if he can. That's what North did here, but you converted it to a Penalty Double by passing.